

Platform Handover — Google Ads Command Center

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For: whoever takes over running and improving this platform after me — written in plain English, no deep technical knowledge assumed. (A separate technical guide, [KNOWLEDGE_TRANSFER.pdf](#), exists for engineers.)

1. What this platform is (in one minute)

It is an internal website ("Command Center") that sits on top of our Google Ads accounts. Instead of logging into Google Ads and switching between ~70 college accounts, the team opens one dashboard to see spend, clicks, leads, and campaign health across everything.

It does four big things:

- 1 **Shows the numbers** — spend, clicks, impressions, leads, CTR, CPL, CPM per account and per campaign.
- 2 **Plans new campaigns with AI** — type a college name and its landing page, and it writes the ads, suggests keywords (with real search volumes), negatives, budgets and a forecast.
- 3 **Runs an approval process** — a manager submits a plan, admins get an email with Approve / Reject buttons, and the manager is told the decision.
- 4 **Manages budgets** — admins set an overall budget per account; account managers plan their weekly and monthly budgets; a summary email goes out every Monday.

Important: the platform only **reads** from Google Ads. It never changes anything in Google Ads automatically. "Approved" means a human said yes — a person still builds the campaign in Google Ads.

2. How to open it and sign in

- 1 **Website:** <https://ads-intelligence-mnr2.onrender.com>
- 1 **Sign in** with your work Google account (the "Sign in with Google" button). Only approved company email addresses can get in.
- 1 If you cannot get in, an existing admin needs to add you (see section 4).

3. Who can do what (two kinds of users)

	Admin	Account Manager (AM)
Who	Ops lead / leadership	Team members running specific accounts
Sees	All accounts	Only the accounts assigned to them
Can	Everything: assign accounts, set overall budgets, approve plans, download reports, add/remove users	View their accounts, generate ad copy, plan weekly/monthly budgets, submit plans for approval

	Admin	Account Manager (AM)
Cannot	—	Download reports, set the overall account budget, or see other people's accounts

This is enforced properly — an AM genuinely cannot see another team's accounts, not just hidden on screen.

4. Managing people (add / assign / remove) — admins only

Go to the **Users & Access** page (left menu, admin only):

- 1 **Add someone:** they simply sign in once with their work Google account; they appear here as a Manager with no accounts yet.
- 1 **Make someone an admin:** change their role to Admin.
- 1 **Give a manager accounts:** click their "assigned" count and tick the accounts they should manage.
- 1 **Remove someone:** click the red **Remove** button next to them (asks you to confirm). They lose all access immediately. Their past work is kept.
- 1 **Account data audit** (bottom of the page): shows each account's most recent data date and flags duplicate account records — useful when the numbers look off (see section 8).

5. A quick tour of the pages

- 1 **Overview** — the home dashboard: total spend for the chosen dates, key numbers, trends, alerts, and an **Account breakdown** you can expand to see each account's campaigns and landing pages. Click a campaign name to open its full detail.
- 1 **Campaign Health / Explorer / Keyword Health / Search Terms / Trends / Budgets** — different views of the live data to spot problems and opportunities.
- 1 **AI Ad Copy Generator** — the planning tool. Type a college + paste its landing page + a budget, click Generate. You get ad copy, keywords (you can add / remove / edit them; new ones get real search volumes), negatives, a budget forecast and a setup guide. Then submit it for approval.
- 1 **Landing Page Auditor** — paste any page URL to check its quality, tracking, broken/leaking links, and whether to reuse or rebuild it. Works for anyone.
- 1 **Campaign Accountability** — plan vs actual per campaign and per manager; admins set each account's **overall budget** here.
- 1 **Budget Planner** — account managers set their **weekly and monthly** budgets for their accounts against that overall allocation.
- 1 **Reports / Priority Queue / Alerts** — exports, a "what to fix first" list, and alerts.

6. The regular routines (what to do and when)

- 1 **Daily:** open Overview, check alerts and the priority list, drill into anything unusual.
- 1 **When launching a new campaign:** use the AI Ad Copy Generator, edit the keywords, submit for approval; an admin approves via email; then build it in Google Ads using the exported plan.

- 1 **Weekly (admins):** each Monday an email summarises last week's budget vs spend per account, with manager names, impressions / clicks / leads / CTR / CPM / CPL, week-on-week changes, and this-month + all-time budgets. You can also send it any time with the "Email admins now" button on the Budget Planner.
- 1 **Monthly (admins):** set or adjust each account's overall budget on Campaign Accountability; account managers update their monthly plans.

7. The behind-the-scenes accounts you now own

The platform depends on a few external services. You (or the company) should take ownership of each:

Service	What it is for	What to do
Google Cloud project	Powers "Sign in with Google" and pulls Google Ads data	Make sure a company admin owns it; keep the login working
Render	Hosts the website and its database	This is where the site runs; billing and settings live here
GitHub repository	Stores all the code	Transfer to a company account so it is not tied to my personal login
Brevo	Sends the emails (approvals, weekly summary)	The email account; keep the sender verified
Google Ads MCC	The actual ad accounts	Unchanged — the platform only reads from it

8. Things you must understand (so numbers do not confuse you)

- 1 **The live site is a copy that does not auto-refresh.** The website on Render shows a **snapshot** of the data; it does not pull fresh data from Google Ads on its own. Fresh data has to be loaded from the source computer. So numbers can lag behind Google Ads — that is expected, not a bug. (An engineer sets up the refresh; see the technical guide.)
- 1 **Numbers can differ from Google Ads** for two honest reasons: (1) the copy above has not been refreshed with today's data, and (2) a "last 30 days" view can cover a slightly different date range. Always compare the same dates.
- 1 **Some accounts appear twice** in the data (a historical import issue). The **Account data audit** flags these. An engineer should clean this up eventually.
- 1 **"Leads" show 0 where conversion tracking is not set up** in Google Ads — that is accurate, not missing data.
- 1 **Emails may first land in Spam** until the sender's domain is fully verified — mark them "Not spam" once.

9. IMPORTANT — things to do at handover (checklist)

- 1 [] **Add the new owner as an Admin** (they sign in once, an existing admin promotes them on Users & Access) — and add their email to the admin list in settings.
- 1 [] **Rotate the passwords and keys** I used during setup (standard security step when someone leaves). Ask an engineer to rotate: the Google sign-in secret, the session key, the Brevo email key, the database password, and the old Gemini AI key. The technical guide lists exactly which ones.

- 1 [] **Transfer the GitHub code** from my personal account to a company account, and give the new engineer access.
 - 1 [] **Confirm the email works** — send the weekly budget email ("Email admins now") and submit a test plan for approval.
 - 1 [] **Confirm data can be refreshed** — make sure someone can run the data sync and update the live site.
 - 1 [] **Read the two companion PDFs:** [PRD.pdf](#) (what the product does and why) and [KNOWLEDGE_TRANSFER.pdf](#) (how it is built, for engineers).
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10. What is still pending / could be improved

- 1 **Clean up the duplicate account records** (the biggest data-quality item).
 - 1 **Make the Monday budget email automatic** on the live site (today it can be sent with a button).
 - 1 Optional future ideas: Meta / Bing ads, more report types, automatic page-speed scoring.
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11. Getting changes made in future

The platform is built so a competent engineer can extend it. When management wants a new feature:

- 1 Point the engineer to [KNOWLEDGE_TRANSFER.pdf](#) — it has step-by-step "recipes" for adding a new page, metric, report, or scheduled email.
 - 2 All the code is in the GitHub repository; changes go live on the site automatically when the code is pushed.
 - 3 Nothing here touches Google Ads directly, so changes are safe to test.
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Companion documents: [PRD.pdf](#) (product spec) and [KNOWLEDGE_TRANSFER.pdf](#) (technical guide). Both are in the project's [docs](#) folder.